

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This Letter to the Editor appeared in a newspaper in Hong Kong:

It is important to fight age discrimination

In a recent report, the incoming head of the Equal Opportunities Commission (EOC), Hong Kong's anti-discrimination office, Alfred Chan Cheung-ming, is quoted as saying that one of his priorities will be to battle against age discrimination.

I hope this will happen as although in the past the EOC has been active in other anti-discriminatory fields, I feel it has not done enough about the problem of discrimination faced by older people.

I wish Mr Chan success in his fight to stop unequal treatment of the elderly, which is one of the most serious forms of discrimination that exists in Hong Kong. I say this because I think it may affect more people in a more truly negative way than any other form of discrimination.

The fact that so many people are forced to leave their employment only because of their age is a terrible aspect of Hong Kong life. In many countries this is no longer the case and there is no reason why Hong Kong should be behind other countries in this area.

Mr Chan's objective to increase work opportunities for senior citizens is an excellent one.

I hope he can pressure the government to pass laws so that people of 60 and above, and sometimes even less than that, can continue in jobs that they are perfectly capable of doing, as well as more easily find jobs related to their expertise and experience. I wish him luck.

Chris Tsui, Discovery Bay

Your class is doing a project on different forms of discrimination in Hong Kong. Your group has been asked to discuss discrimination against older people. You may want to talk about:

- advantages of allowing older people to work
- advantages of not allowing older people to work
- what can be done to reduce discrimination against older people
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to work when you are over 60?
2. How can older people spend their time if they are not working?
3. Why do some employers not want older workers?
4. What age do you think people should retire at?
5. What advantages can older workers bring to a company?
6. Do you think people will retire at a later age in the future?
7. Why do you think people want to continue working after 60?
8. Do young people also suffer age discrimination?